

- Check the overall performance of the fund through multiple quarters and see if it is among the best performing funds among other funds in the same category.
 - Keep monitoring where the funds are investing money. As long as the fund is investing as per its stated objective, it is fine. E.g. a small cap fund should not start investing in large cap stocks.
 - Keep a watch on any change in fund manager, though just this change is not a good enough reason to leave a good performing fund
- Continue with your SIPs in Mutual Funds "for ever".

Gold

All of you must have dealt with gold at some stage of your life. I have also dealt with gold, but mainly used to see it once a year in my bank locker. It had become more of a liability off late since I had to pay locker rentals to the bank where I kept the gold in safe custody.

My views on gold have changed a lot during my journey towards financial freedom, as I saw its price fluctuating daily in the market.

Here are my recommendations on gold as an investment tool:

- Gold is a more secure investment than mutual funds. Not only that, it is a decent performer too.
- You should start investing in gold at the same time as you start in mutual funds i.e., within 9–12 months of starting your journey.
- First of all, you should completely forget physical gold as any kind of useful investment tool. Physical gold only has ornamental value and in today's world of artificial jewellery, I do not give too much significance to keeping gold as an ornament.
- You need to purchase gold ETFs or the new government backed gold bonds. For this, as you have already seen, you will need to open a Demat account.
- Once you have a demat account, start buying 1 or 2 units of any of the gold ETFs at regular intervals or at dips. I have personally